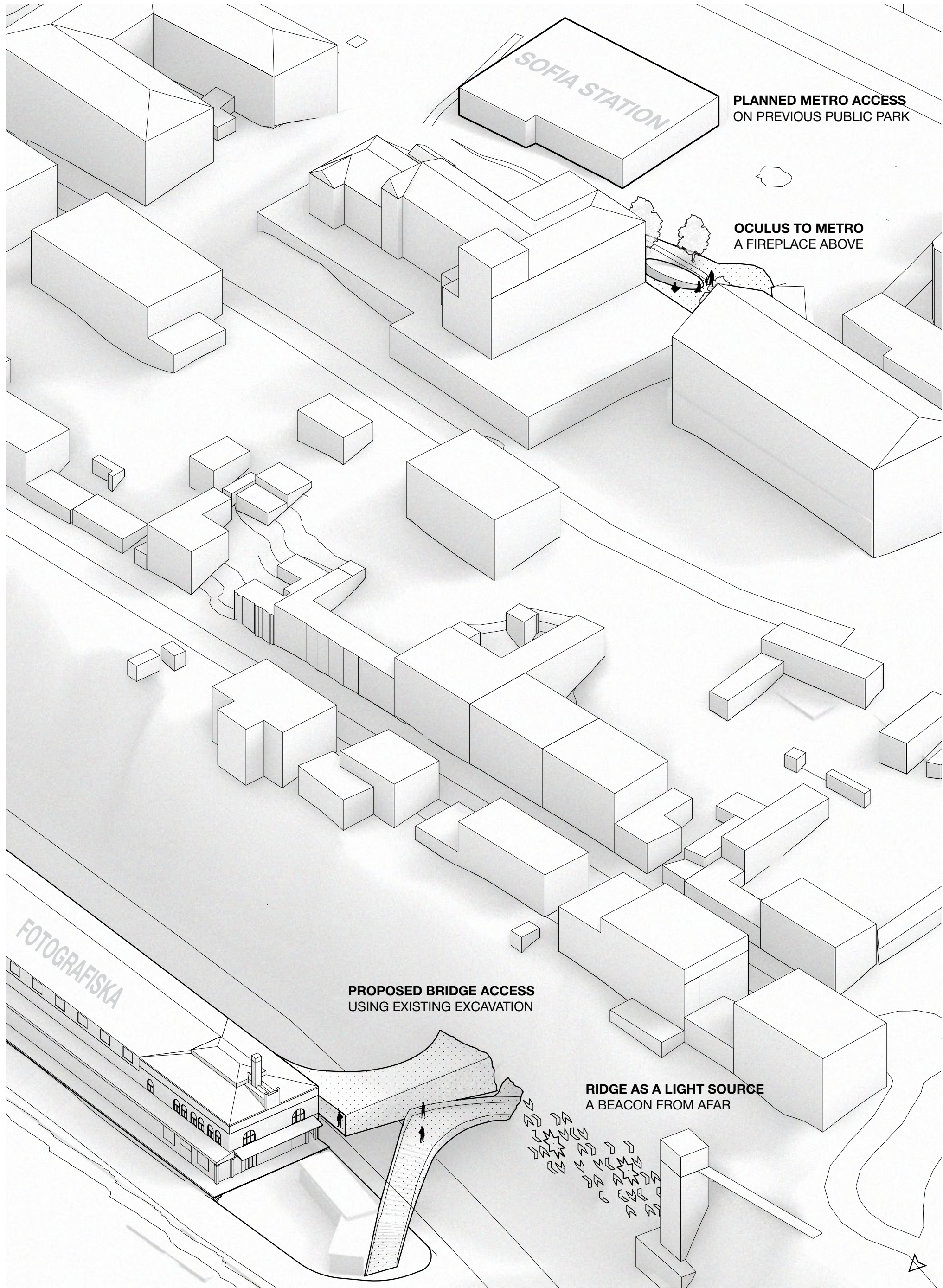
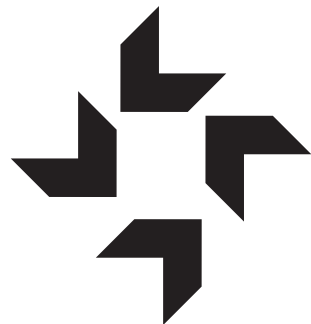




DEPTH OF FIELD

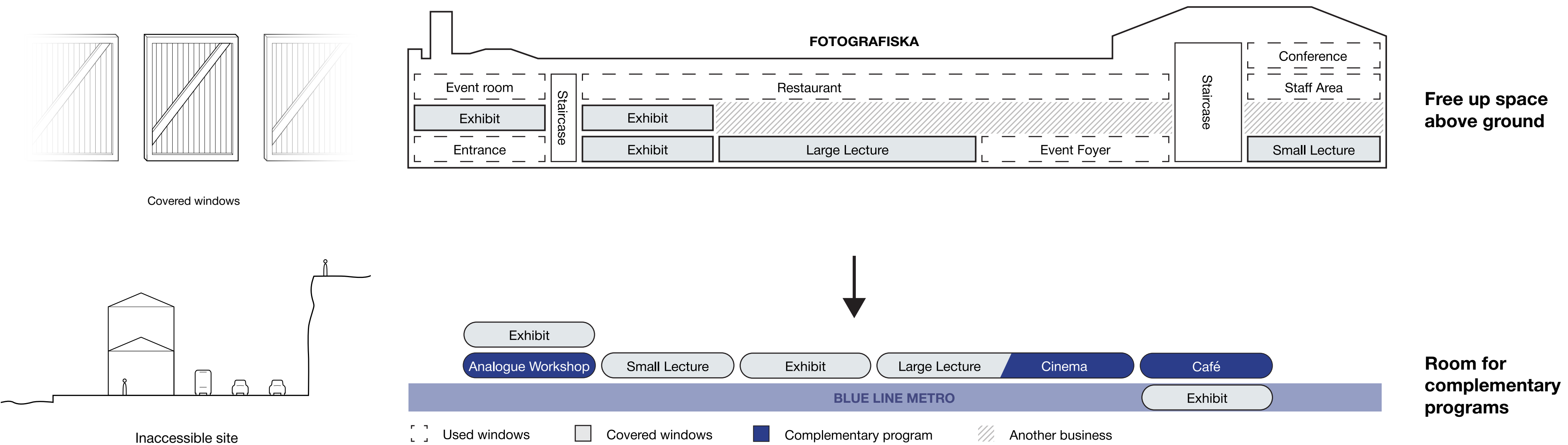
RELIEVING FOTOGRAFISKA OF THE OVERGROUND

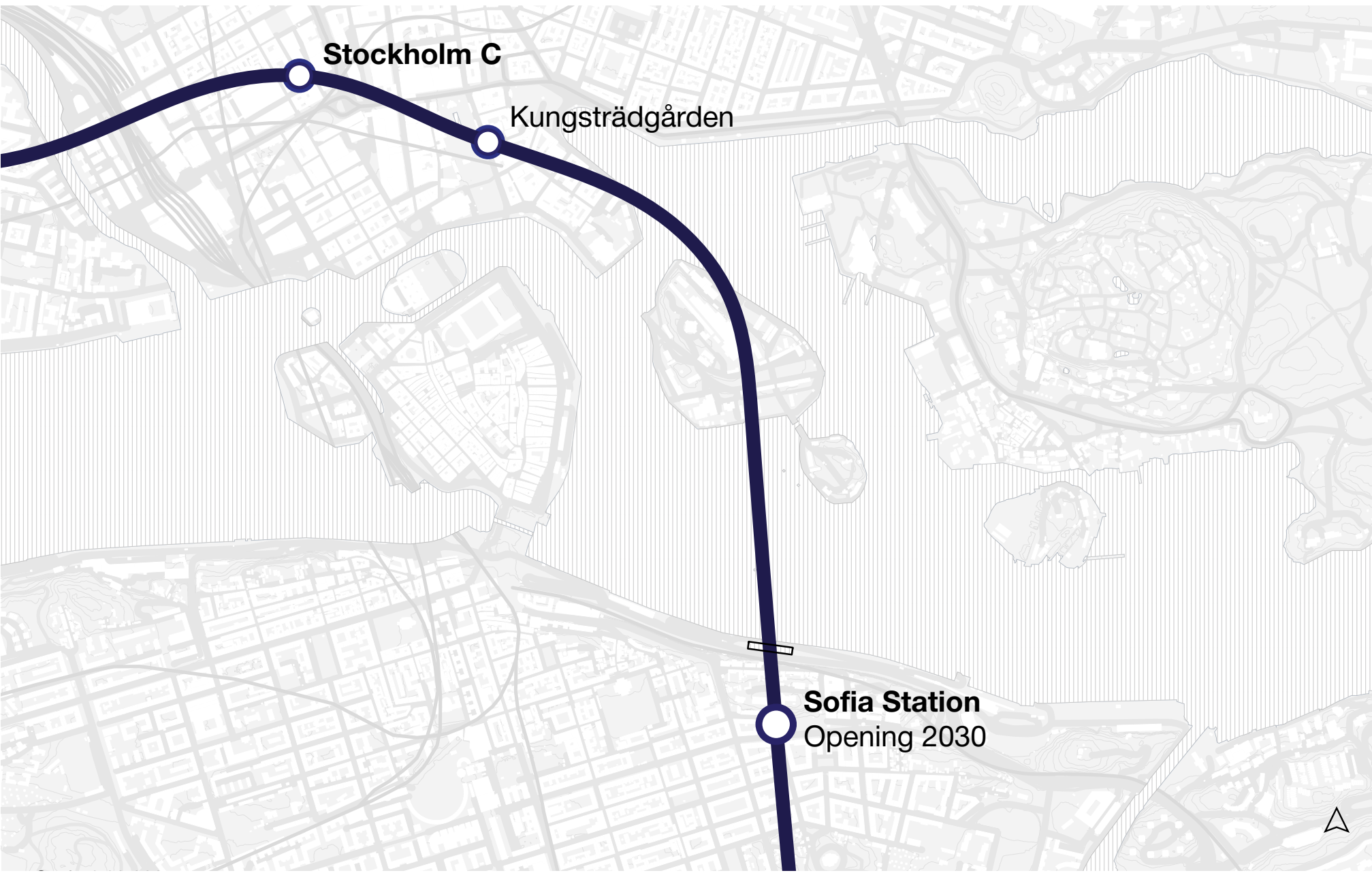


Location: Södermalm, Stockholm, Sweden

Fotografiska is housed in a former customs building, a structure of significant historical value that lends the museum cultural weight and identity. However, this heritage also imposes limitations on the way exhibitions can be presented. The fact that many of the building's windows are permanently covered highlights a mismatch between the existing architecture and the needs of the museum, suggesting that certain exhibition spaces would be better suited below ground.

By embedding parts of the museum within the earth, the exhibition programs are given the freedom to expand and adapt without being constrained by the existing building fabric. At the same time, this strategy frees the above-ground spaces for programs that benefit from the historical character of the building—spaces that are enhanced by its architecture rather than restricted by it. In this way, the intervention allows the museum to respect its heritage while extending its spatial and curatorial possibilities.





Urban Context Scale: 1:20000



The museum becomes a scenic route compared to the metro’s traditional lift access.

A Waterfront Icon with Limited Access

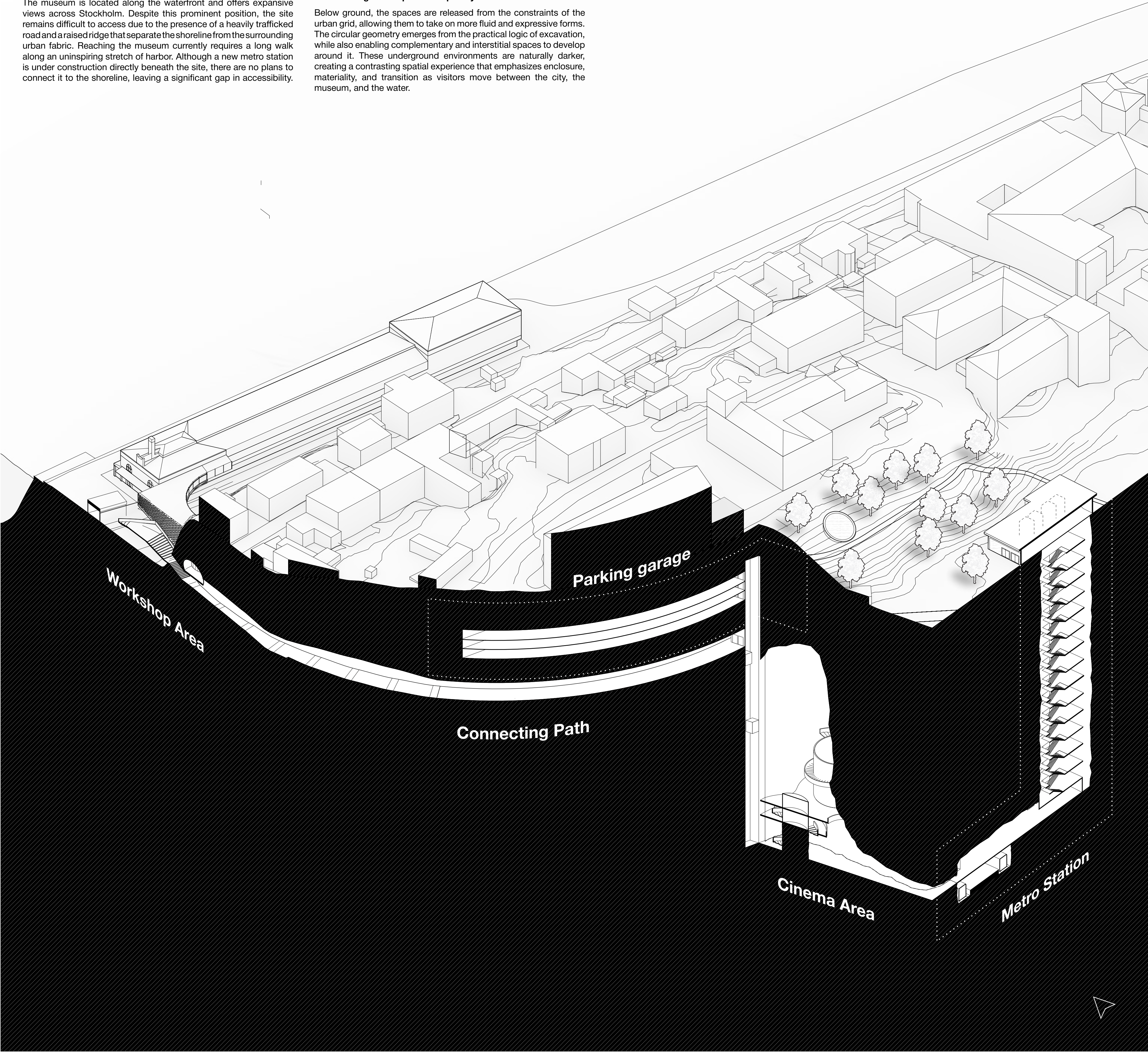
The museum is located along the waterfront and offers expansive views across Stockholm. Despite this prominent position, the site remains difficult to access due to the presence of a heavily trafficked road and a raised ridge that separate the shoreline from the surrounding urban fabric. Reaching the museum currently requires a long walk along an uninspiring stretch of harbor. Although a new metro station is under construction directly beneath the site, there are no plans to connect it to the shoreline, leaving a significant gap in accessibility.

Extending Downward to Reconnect the City

The museum responds to this condition by extending downward, connecting to existing underground spaces and using the subsurface as a means of overcoming the physical barriers above ground. By moving below the surface, the project creates a continuous public route that links the metro, the museum, and the waterfront, making the shoreline accessible where it was previously disconnected.

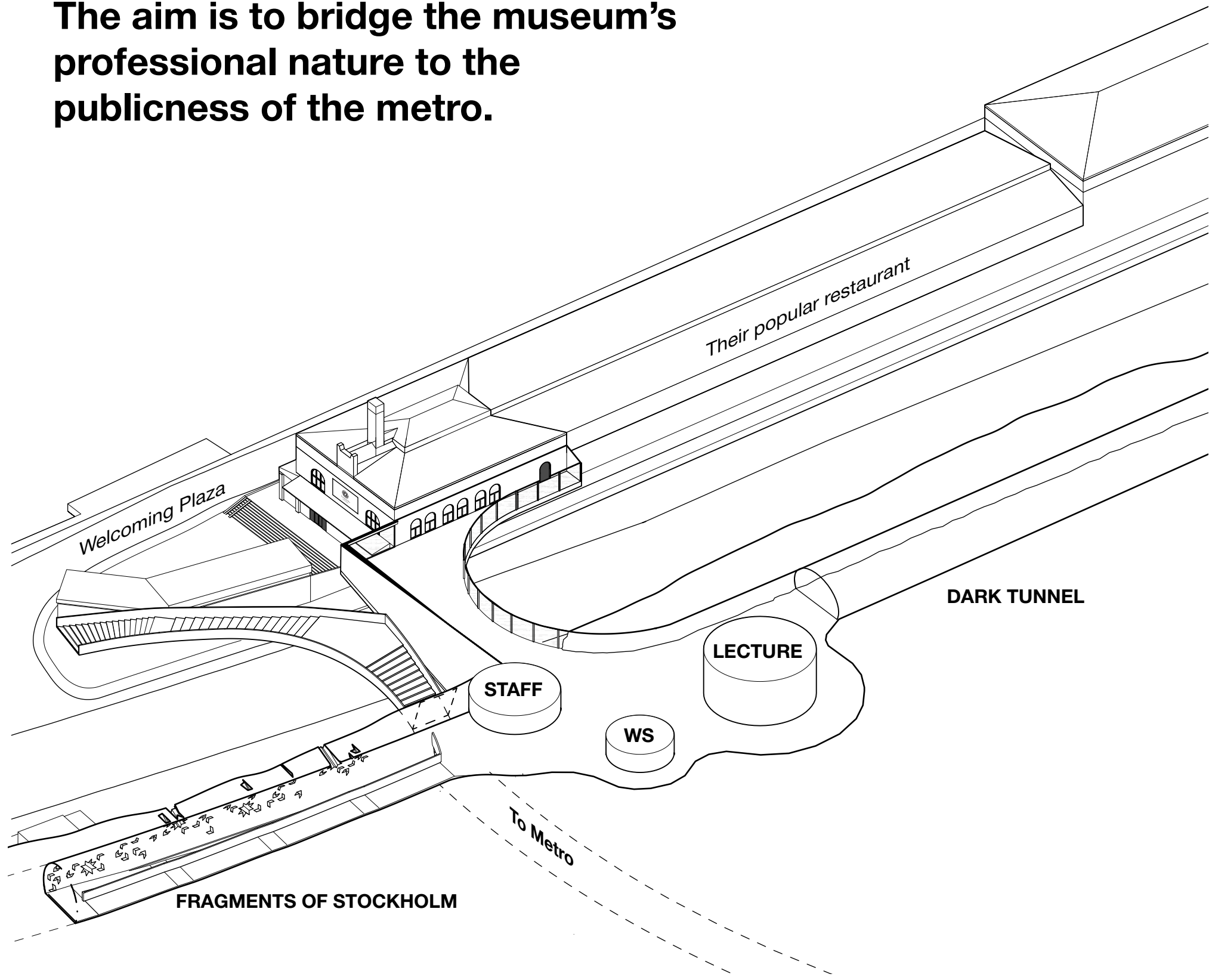
Fluid Underground Spaces Shaped by Excavation

Below ground, the spaces are released from the constraints of the urban grid, allowing them to take on more fluid and expressive forms. The circular geometry emerges from the practical logic of excavation, while also enabling complementary and interstitial spaces to develop around it. These underground environments are naturally darker, creating a contrasting spatial experience that emphasizes enclosure, materiality, and transition as visitors move between the city, the museum, and the water.



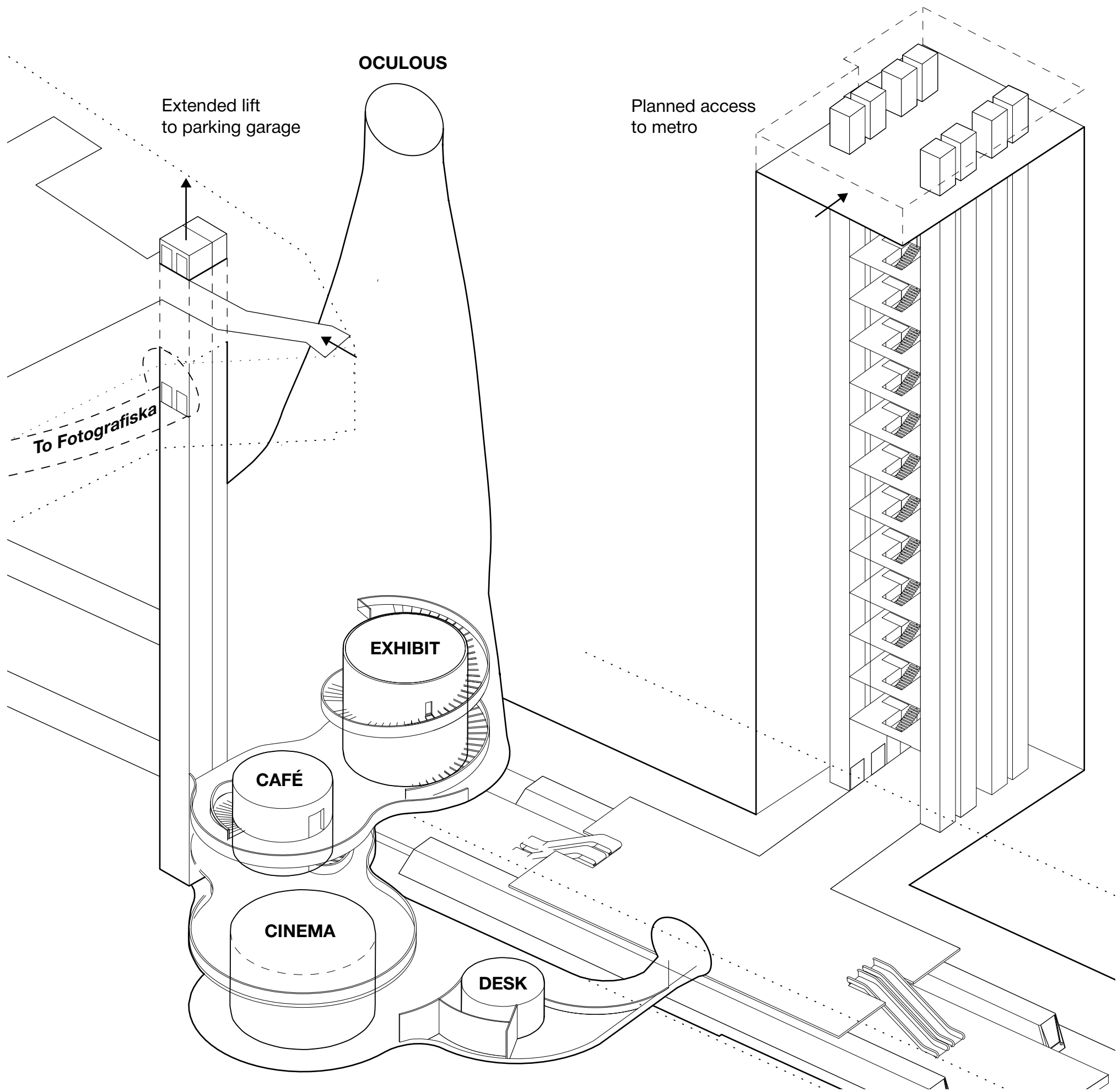
Overview Section Axonometric Scale: 1:600

The aim is to bridge the museum’s professional nature to the publicness of the metro.



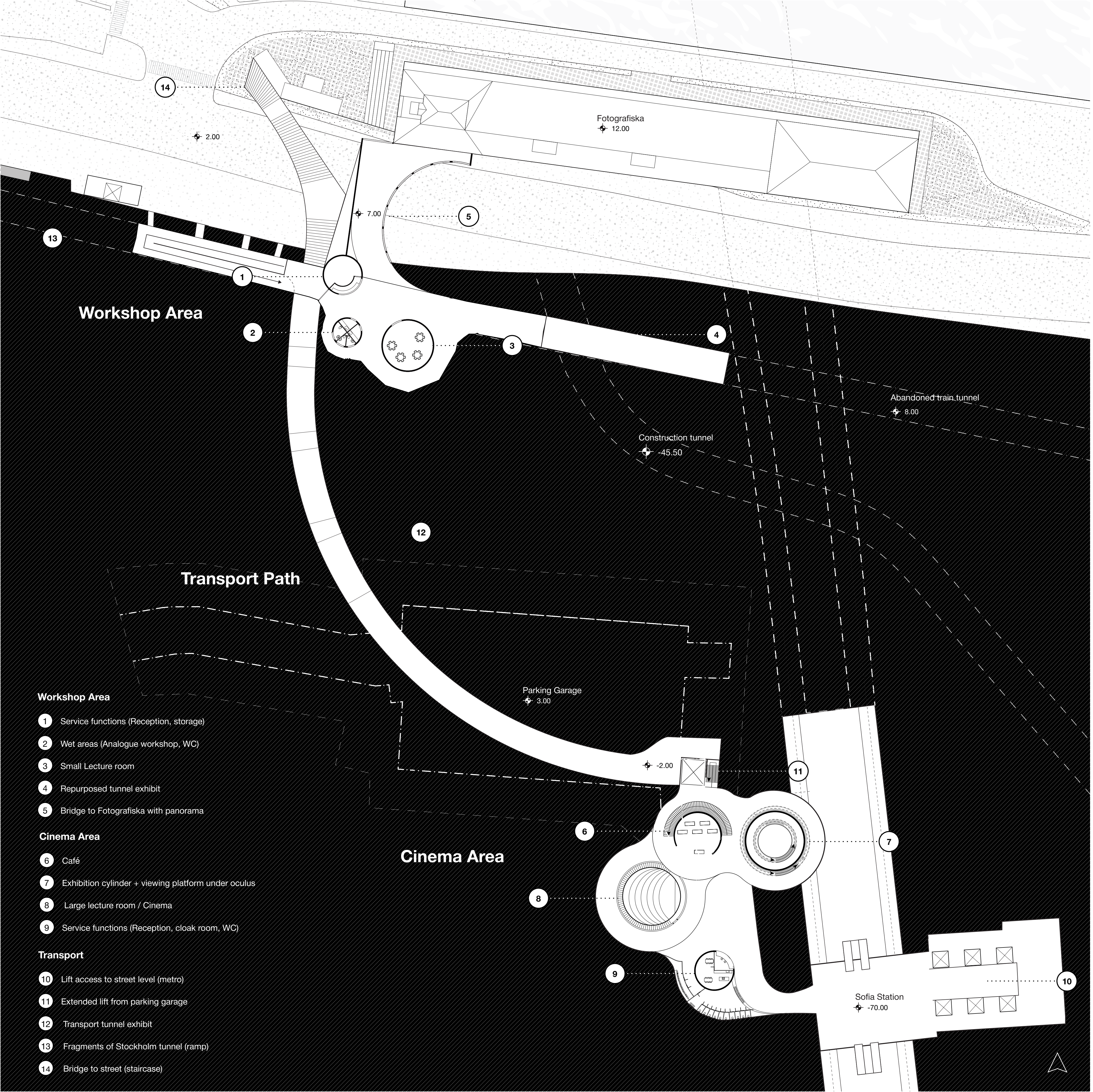
The Chamber
Workshop area

The workshop functions as a platform where visitors can delve deeper into the art form and engage directly with the professional community.



The Lens
Cinema area

The cinema extends the photography-museum typology by introducing a familiar program and helping a broader audience find their way here.



Overview Floor Plan Scale: 1:500

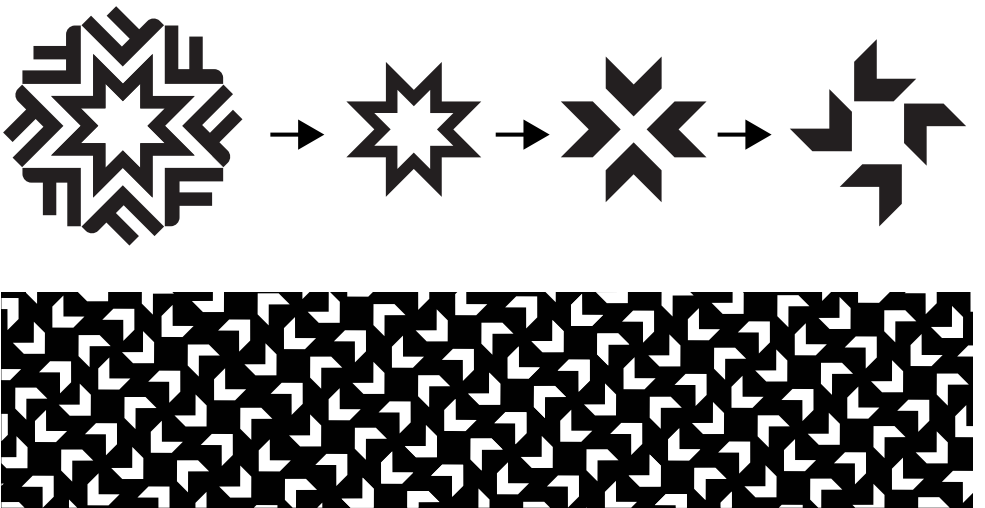
The Composition

Snapshots of the journey to the surface

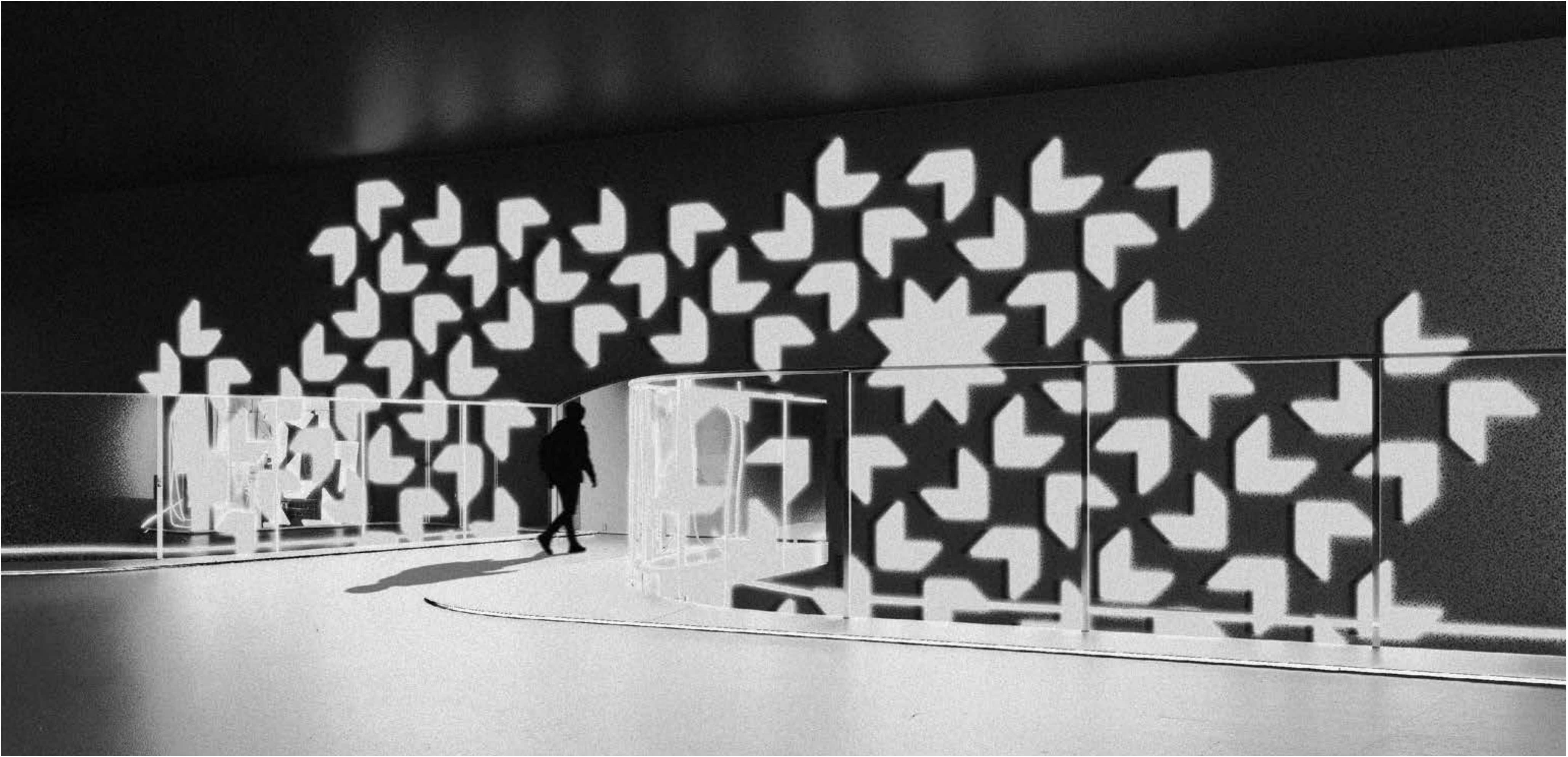
In the metro, visitors are greeted by a pattern composed of fragments of Fotografiska's logo, offering an early cue to the journey ahead. From here, they enter a transitional tunnel designed to soften the shift from the station's harsh atmosphere. Within a few meters, the tunnel begins to widen into a cave-like space where a circular staircase appears, inviting you to explore the stepped levels that rise toward the lens, 100 meters above.

Above the first staircase is a shared space where metro travelers can pause for a coffee or watch a film, and where museum visitors begin their ascent toward the cylindrical exhibition volume above.

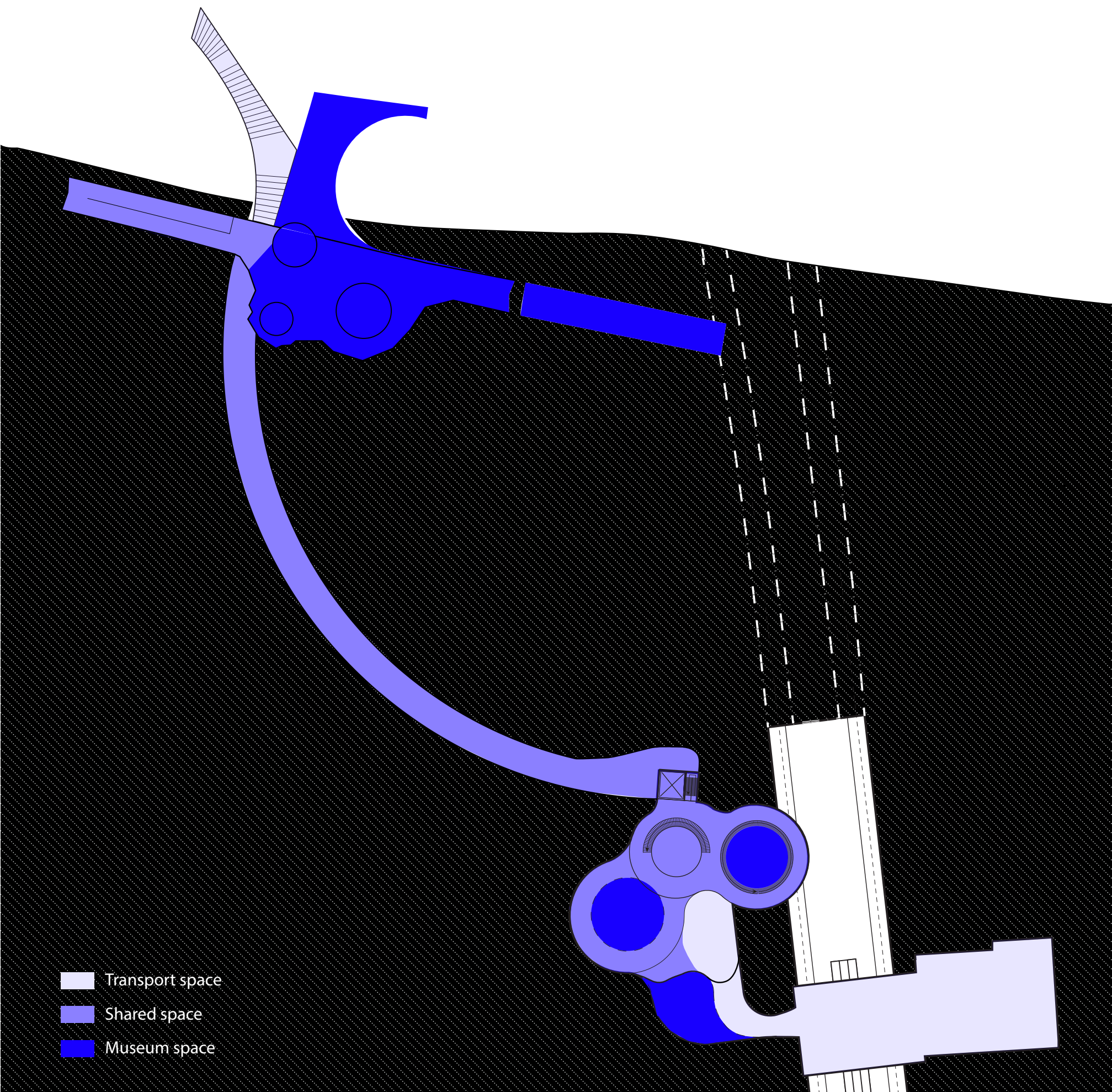
Continuing to the surface, the elevator carries visitors to a level just beneath the existing parking structure. From there, a tunnel leads toward an exit in the ridge. It is along this passage that the worlds of the museum and the public truly intersect.



The Fotografiska logo is used for educational and illustrative purposes only. All rights belong to Fotografiska. (www.fotografiska.com)



1. Access from metro



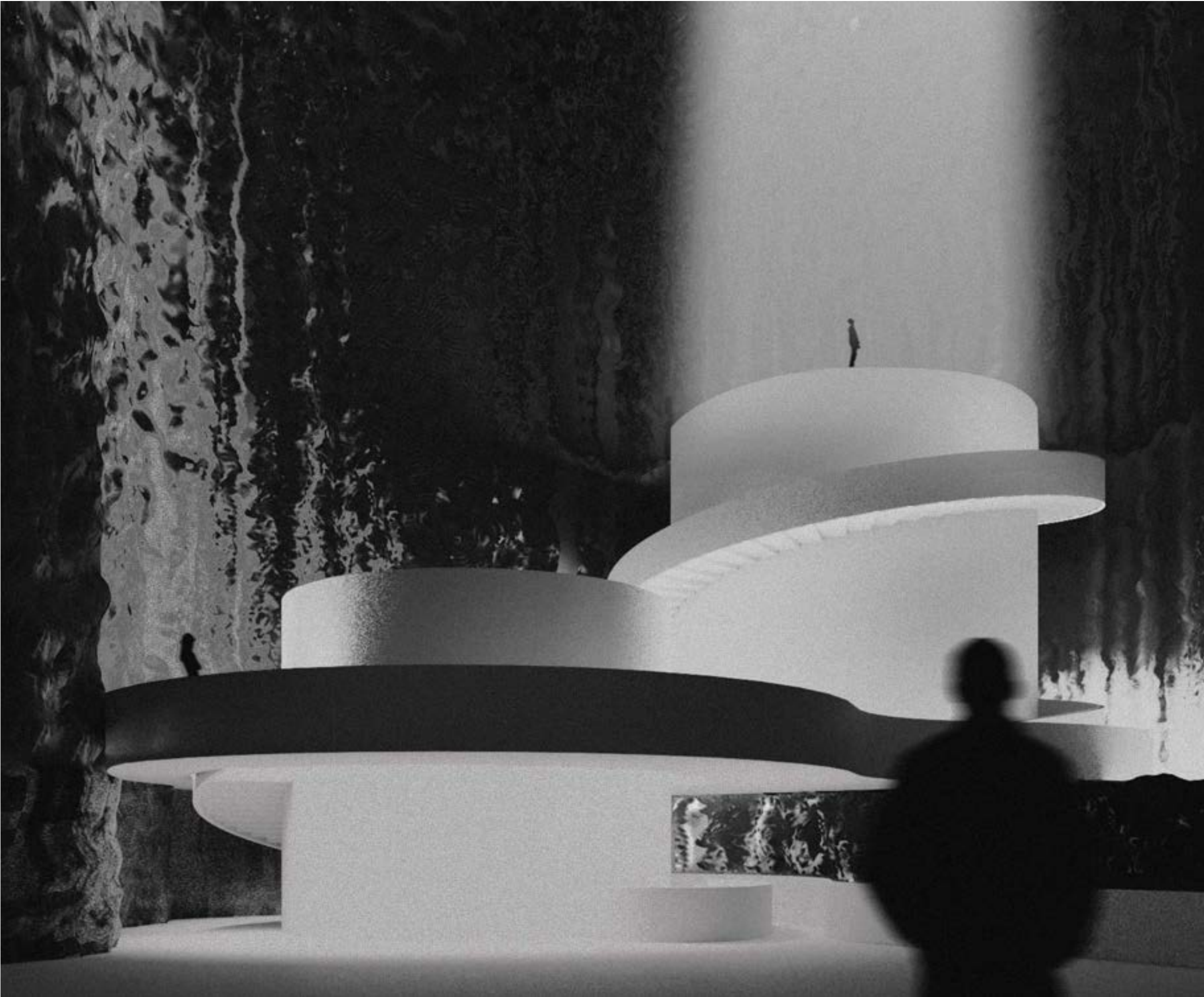
Plan of journey Scale: 1:1000



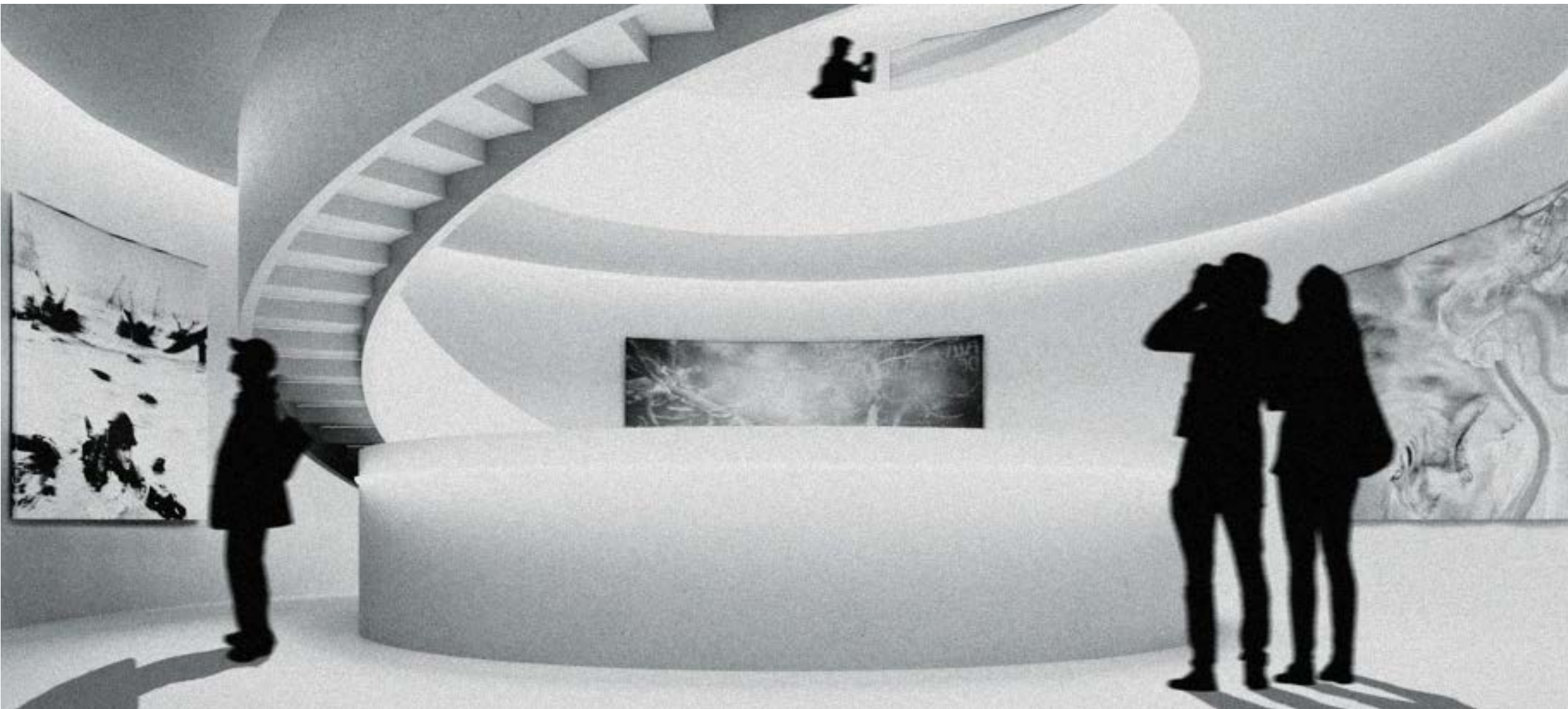
2. Cinema area



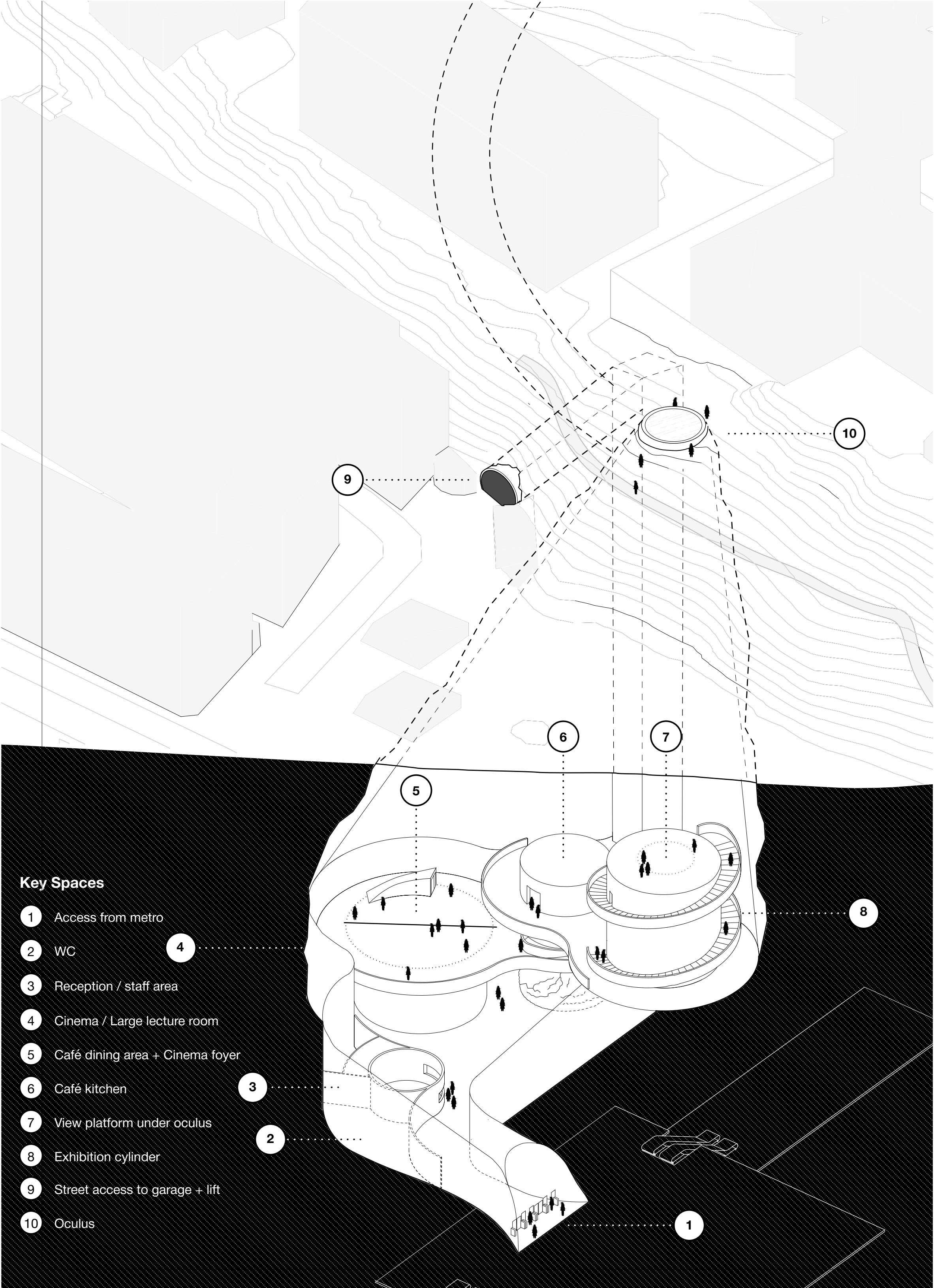
3. Transport path



View of Lens View standing at cinema entrance looking over exhibit cylinder, viewing light inlet from lens opening on surface level



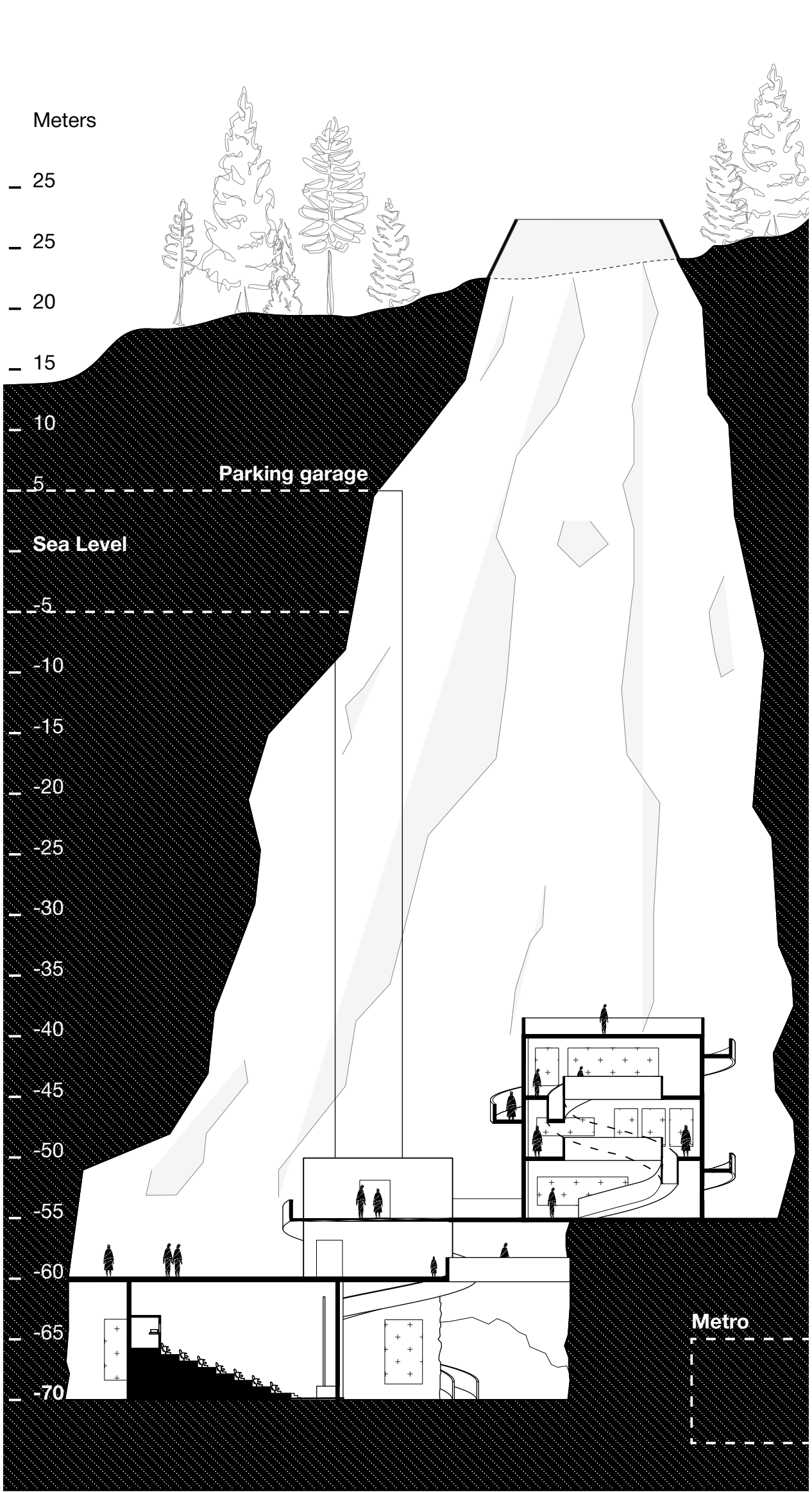
Cylinder exhibit Cylindrical exhibit hall within



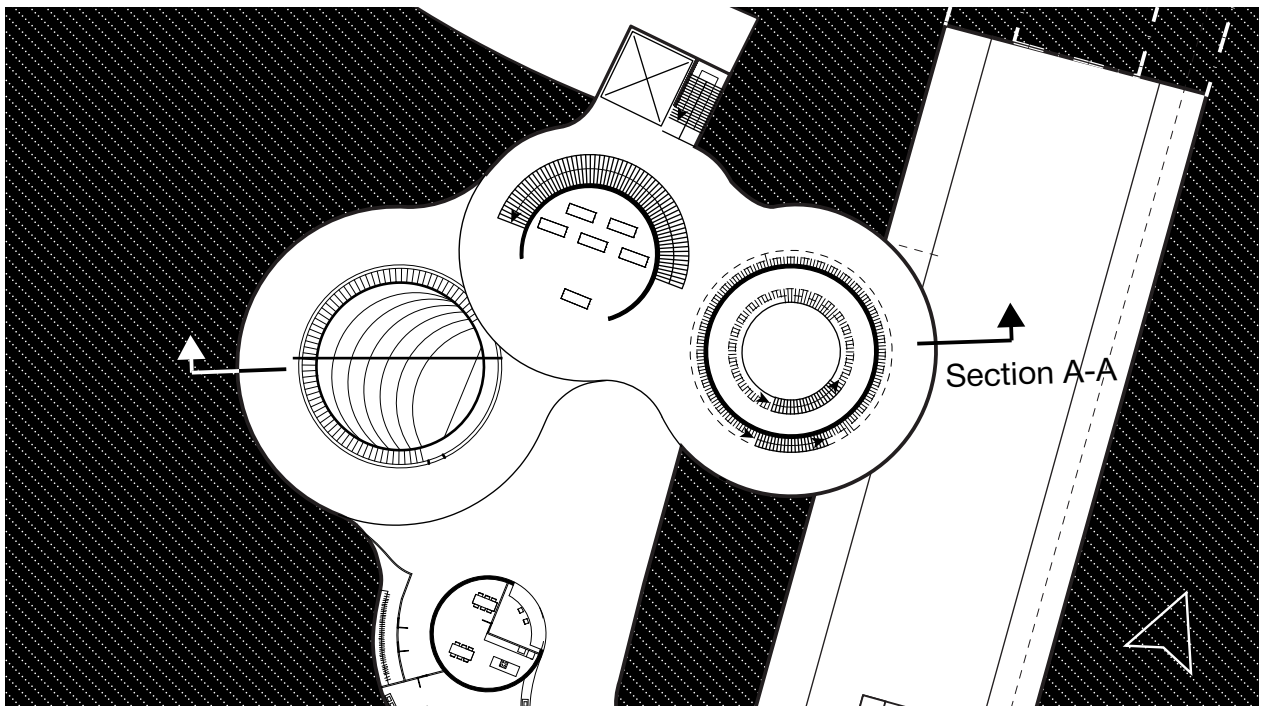
Key Spaces

- 1 Access from metro
- 2 WC
- 3 Reception / staff area
- 4 Cinema / Large lecture room
- 5 Café dining area + Cinema foyer
- 6 Café kitchen
- 7 View platform under oculus
- 8 Exhibition cylinder
- 9 Street access to garage + lift
- 10 Oculus

Axonometric drawing Scale: 1:400



Section A-A Scale: 1:400



Floor Plan Scale: 1:800

Under the Lens

The Cinema Area

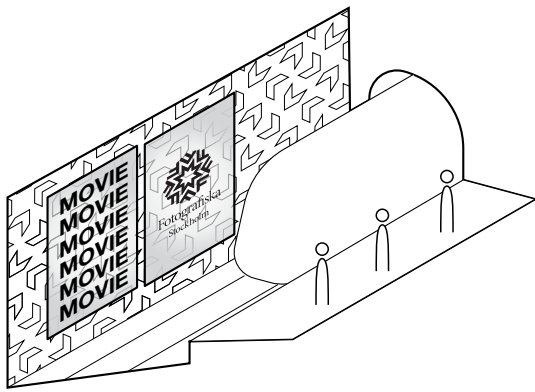
Connecting the museum to the metro makes it more accessible and integrated into the city, encouraging visits from both locals and tourists. The cinema serves as a anchor, drawing people in and adding a dynamic

layer of activity to complement the calm of the exhibition spaces.

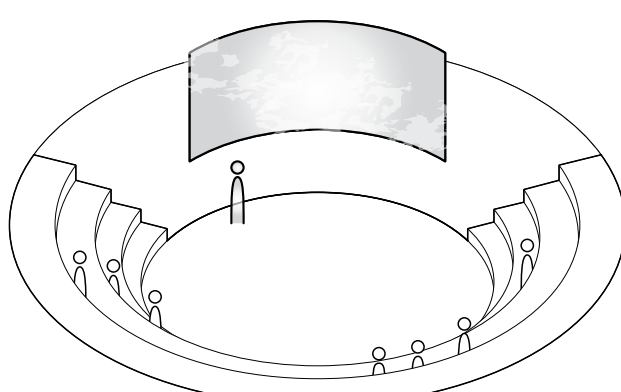
While the galleries offer reflection and stillness, the cinema introduces movement, sound, and shared experiences, attracting a broader audience who may then explore the rest of the museum. By combining accessibility with diverse programming, the museum balances quiet contemplation with vibrant social interaction. The cinema supports the exhibitions, activates circulation, and extends the time

visitors spend in the building, transforming the museum into a lively cultural hub that engages both the city and its community.

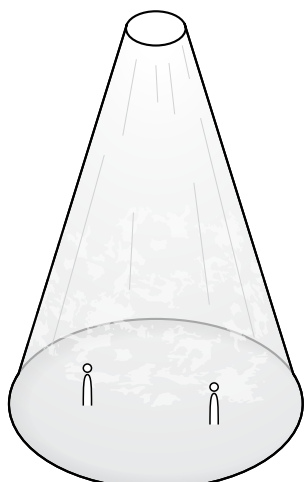
The floors are planned to focus on the transport path on the lowest floor and the museum on the highest. The café is where they meet and where you would pass by on your way to exploring the next area.



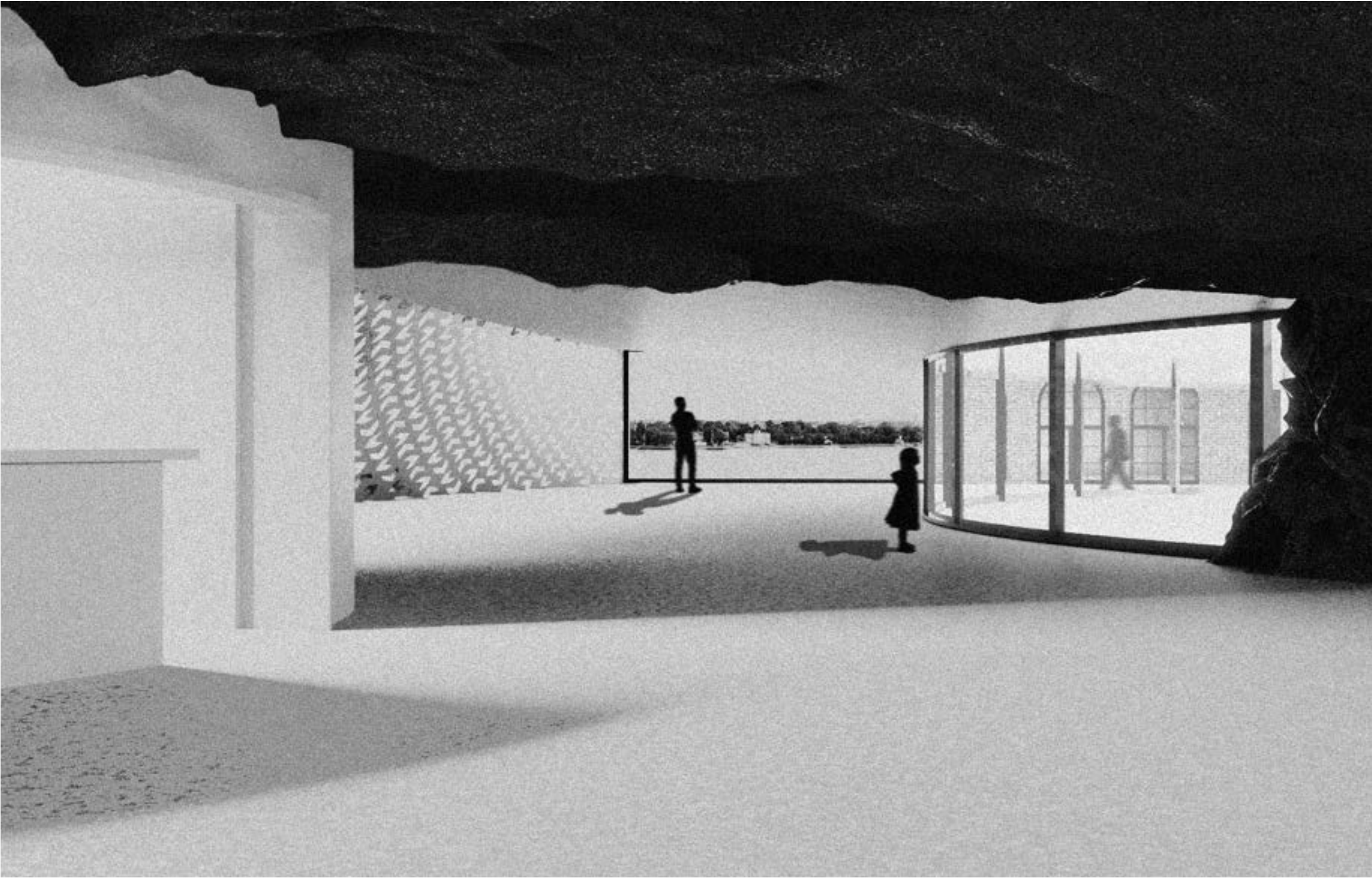
Attract the public by connecting to the metro



Host their regular lectures / or invite the public to see a movie



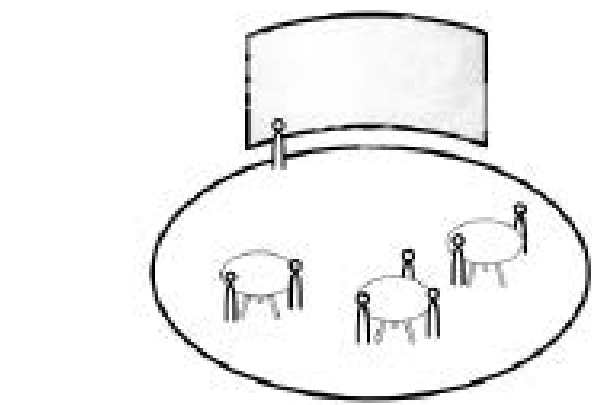
The lens creates a dramatic picture and unites people under its 100 meters depth.



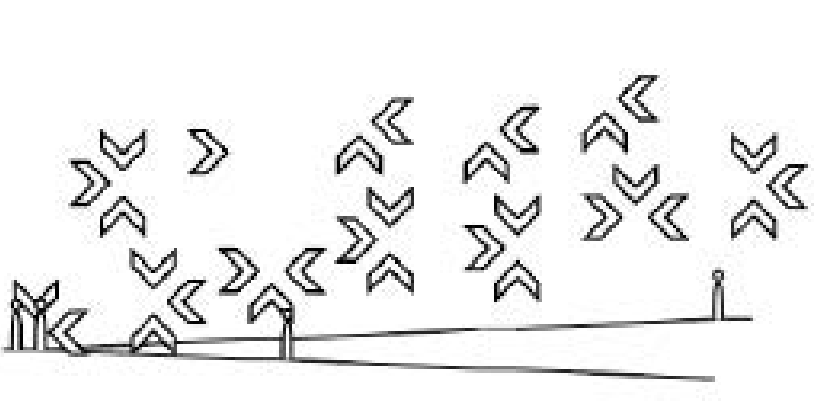
The final photo The elevated bridge gives you a clear view of the Stockholm skyline, and acts as the final photo in the museum path.



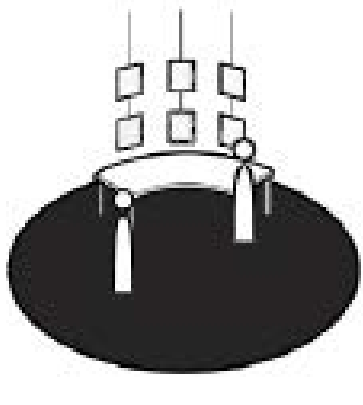
The transitioning path Part of the abandoned train tunnel becomes a photogenic path which transitions the metro movement to the workshop's focus.



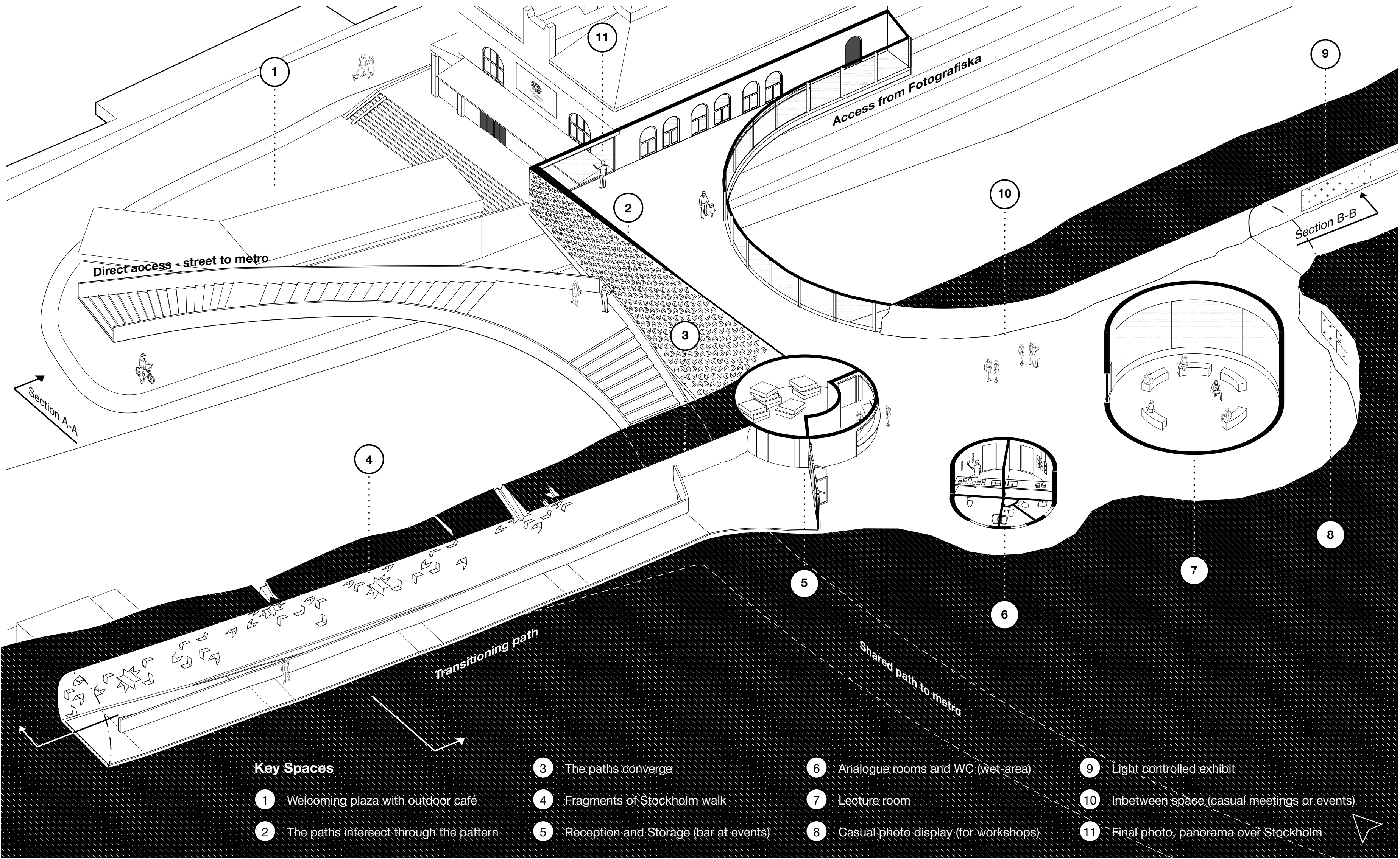
Their regular lectures / or a workshop which creates a bridge between the professional and the public



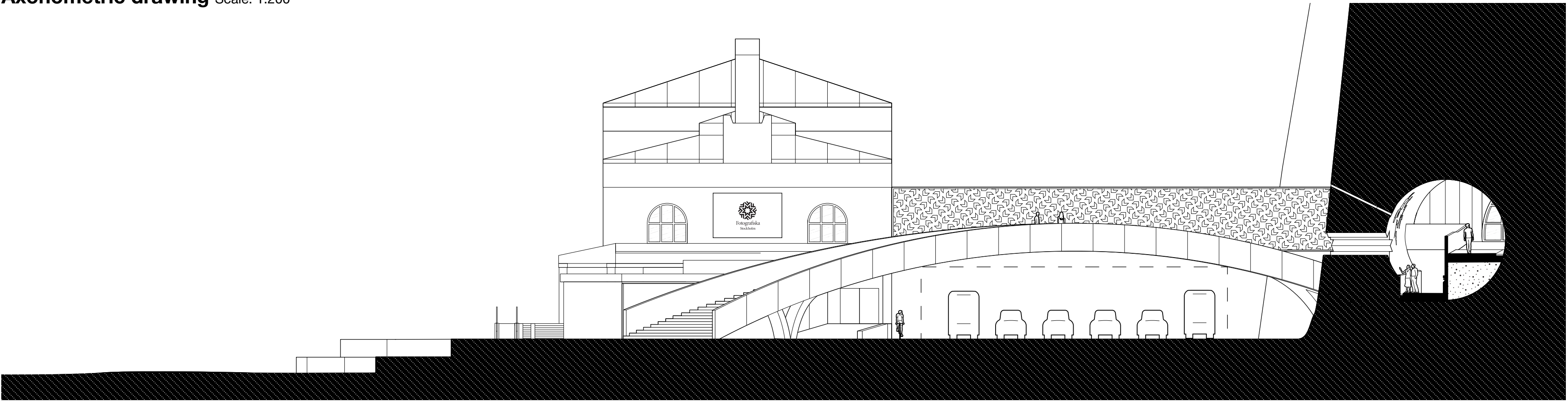
The logo fragments on the ridge becomes a picture on the inside and a beacon from afar.



The analogue workshops gain its strength from the total darkness of the underground.



Axonometric drawing Scale: 1:200



Section A-A Scale: 1:200

Inside the Chamber

The Workshop area

The space is formed around an abandoned train tunnel, which serves as the central organizing element of the excavation. Along this tunnel, designated rooms are shaped as cylindrical volumes that interrupt and break the linear nature of the space, creating a sequence of varied spatial

conditions. These cylindrical rooms help define different programs while maintaining visual and physical connections throughout the interior.

This space is designed to accommodate regular lectures that were previously housed elsewhere in the building, providing dedicated areas for learning and discussion. In addition to its use for lectures, the space can open up to support workshops and more interactive forms of education. Users are able to move between learning in the lecture spaces, producing work in the workshop areas, and displaying what they have created throughout

the surrounding spaces. This allows circulation areas to function as informal exhibition zones, encouraging engagement and exchange.

The staff area houses a reception that acts as the main point of entry and orientation within the building. This reception is designed to be flexible and can double as a bar, allowing the space to open up for events, exhibitions, and social gatherings. Through this adaptability, the project supports both its everyday educational use and its transformation into an active public venue.